

# Bringing Clarity to the Chaos in AI

AI feels powerful, yet most teams struggle because they cannot define what intelligence they really need. But there are ways to address this challenge.

**F**or anyone working with AI, the blinding speed of growth is a constant struggle. The field never slows down, and staying updated becomes a daily task.

I think I can share a personal experience which may help you relate to the effect this kind of speed has on all of us. Back in 2003, let's say someone bought a bike, registered it, and fixed the number plate with a white background and yellow font. A week later, the government would change the rule — the number plate must now be white with black lettering. Two weeks later, the rule would change again. With this constant change, at some point, some people decided to put every possible format on one number plate so that, no matter what rule came next, they were technically covered. This was a common problem for anyone who got their driving licences during 2003-2005.

I, too, went through this confusion when I got my licence in 2005. And this is precisely what developing AI applications feels like today.

If you are an AI developer, you already know the biggest pain point. The field is changing so fast that even a small break can set you behind exponentially. You return to your team after a small holiday, and within minutes, someone says, "You are out of date; something has changed." This is how fast the stacks, algorithms and platforms are evolving.

Transformation itself is not new. The industry has seen the birth of the internet, cloud computing, mobility, and even earlier phases of AI. But what makes this phase different is that AI's



scope is undefined. Leaders across industries use the phrase: "everything everywhere." Unlike cloud or internet, both of which have clear functional boundaries, AI has no obvious box. What exactly should AI do for a business? Where does it stop? How do we define the scope?

This lack of definition is the root problem. AI is everywhere, but organisations do not know what "everything" should mean for them.

To solve this, I work with four principles that help create clarity: Define, Target, Scale, and Grow.

## Define

The first principle is to define the level of intelligence required in a solution. We must be deliberate here because not every problem needs an LLM or a deep learning model. The principle can be handled on three levels.

### *Good old-fashioned AI (GOFAI):*

At its core, GOFAI is a rule-based system. The logic sits in the code. If the business rule changes, we simply edit the rule. GOFAI remains extremely useful, practical, and the right answer for many use cases. There is no need to complicate everything.

**Machine learning:** We use ML when the system needs to learn from patterns rather than rules. This is where training data, predictions, supervised and unsupervised learning come in.

**Complex AI:** This includes deep learning, dynamic models, advanced architectures and LLMs. While AI needs to evolve, setting limits is just as important. At each stage, simply keep evaluating the question 'Is the current level of complexity strictly necessary to resolve the customer's problem?' Often, the honest answer is 'no'.

Developers must therefore pause and choose the minimum intelligence level that meets the requirement. Nothing more. Nothing less.

## Target

The second principle is about targeting the business problem the right way. AI application development looks like the traditional SDLC, but there is one major difference. In software development, we design, code, test, deploy and maintain. But AI adds a permanent, mandatory last step: refinement. This is not the same as iterative development. Refinement is a continuous loop built into the system itself. Feedback from customers and users must be collected, analysed and fed back into the model regularly. Without refinement, an AI